KiqStat CTO review: second pass

What your Paystack export, backups screenshot, decisions and ticks changed. 6 November 2026. Follows the first-pass report (cto-review-first-pass-2026-11) and your task list (founder-tasks-second-pass-2026-11)

1. Summary

- **The 24 October "missed renewal" is explained, and it is good news.** The Paystack export shows the member's ₦12,000 card charge at 1:15 PM that day with the status **reversed**: the card issuer took it back. No money was kept and no webhook was lost. Item 1.5 is closed.
- **The Paystack export matches our database exactly:** 14 successful payments, ₦77,750, the same people and amounts. Nothing is missing. The October statement (2.1) is final.
- **Card payments at checkout are almost dead.** Card: 48 attempts, 2 successes (4%), none since 8 October. Bank and bank transfer (OPay, PalmPay): 21 attempts, 12 successes (57%). This is the biggest revenue finding so far.
- **Real fees were lower than my estimate.** From 19 October the buyer pays Paystack's fee on top, so we paid only ₦574 in October. Real customers left us **₦76,676**.
- **I found and fixed a bug in Ask KiqStat** that the benchmark exposed: when it used the pick cards it wrote its answer twice (4 of 40 answers).
- **All your approved decisions are in the code on dev**, along with the refund email and the improved renewal check.
- **Still waiting on you:** GA4 and Mixpanel, the Anthropic billing figures, the carousel images and fixtures, 5.1 and 5.3, the ad spend, and the merge and promote.

2. What your inputs closed

Item	Result
1.3 Backups	Closed. Screenshot received: daily physical backups every night at about 00:28 UTC, 30 October to 6 November. The weekly off-site copy was restored into a scratch database and matched production on all seven tables (section 5)
1.4 ₦500 pass refund	Waived by you; the purchase itself is confirmed in Paystack (31 Oct, ₦500, settled 1 Nov)
1.5 Renewal anomaly	Closed: the charge was reversed by the card issuer (section 3)
2.1 Revenue statement	Final, reconciled to Paystack (section 3)
2.2 Invoices	Closed: the estimated range ₦95,000 to ₦108,000 a month is treated as the real cost

Item	Result
2.4 Free tier and operating profit	Final on that basis (section 4)
2.5 Allowance versus cap	Approved: VIP allowance lowered from 100 to 80 a day so it matches the US$0.10 day cap
5.2 Commission schedule	Approved: 20% standard, 25% named, 30% ceiling; the ceiling in the admin is now 30% (it was 50%)

3. Reconciling October with Paystack

Source: your Paystack export for 1 to 31 October, 72 rows. Three rows are our own `@kiqstat.app` test checkouts and are left out.

Paystack status	Count	Notes
Successful	14	₦77,750, identical to our payments table, including the ₦500 test pass
Abandoned	53	The buyer opened checkout and left, or never sent the transfer
Failed	1	A transfer closed by timeout
Reversed	1	The 24 October ₦12,000 VIP renewal

Fees. Paystack's fees total ₦2,393.60. Four early payments (4 and 8 October) carried fees paid by us: ₦573.75. From 19 October the checkout adds the fee to the customer's price (₦5,177.67 for a ₦5,000 plan), so the ten payments after that cost us nothing. Real money received from real customers: **₦76,676**, against the ₦74,891 I estimated earlier.

What this means for pricing and partners. With the buyer paying the fee, a ₦5,000 Pro sale brings in the full ₦5,000. Break-even on the estimated costs is therefore about 19 to 22 Pro sales a month with no partner. Partner commission is still calculated on the price minus an *estimated* fee, even though the buyer now pays that fee, so partners are paid slightly less than a price-based rule would give (about 3% less on a ₦5,000 sale). It needs no change now, but raise it when the Partner Agreement V2 is written.

The 24 October renewal, in full. Paystack charged the card at 1:15 PM ("Approved by Financial Institution"), then the status became reversed. The member's period ended that day, so access ended with it, correctly. The daily subscription check now recognises a reversed charge and says so in its email, so it will stop calling this "unexplained". The member has already been given a gifted month. Paystack still shows the subscription active with the next charge on 24 November.

3.1 The 24 October X ad

You ran an X ad that day. Our records for people who signed up on 24 October: **37 signups, 10 from X links, 7 of them tried to pay, 2 paid, ₦17,000.** The Paystack export shows nine checkout attempts that day (four people on the ₦12,000 VIP price), and only one completed that

evening. One buyer tried six times between 24 and 30 October (five bank transfers left unpaid, one card) and finally paid ₦12,000 on 4 November.

I cannot judge the ad's return without its cost. **Please send the ad spend** and I will put it beside ₦17,000 and the later purchases from that cohort.

3.2 Payment method

Method	Attempts	Successful	Rate
Card	48	2	4% (both on 8 October)
Bank (OPay and others)	9	7	78%
Bank transfer (PalmPay, OPay, others)	12	5	42%

Of the 25 card attempts after 19 October, none succeeded; 45 of 48 card attempts ended "The transaction was not completed", meaning the buyer reached the card form and left. Seven bank-transfer attempts ended "Awaiting Transfer": the buyer asked for an account number and never paid.

Recommendation (a decision for you, not changed in code): make bank and bank transfer the first thing a buyer sees at checkout, and consider hiding or demoting card until we learn why it fails. I have not changed the checkout because I cannot verify here how Paystack orders its payment tabs; the change is small once you agree, and it is the cheapest revenue gain available.

4. Money position (final on the accepted costs)

	₦ per month
October collected from real customers	77,250
Received after the fees we bore	76,676

	₦ per month
Estimated fixed costs (accepted as real)	95,000 to 108,000
Result	**about 18,000 to 31,000 short**
Pro monthly sales needed to cover costs, no partner	19 to 22

October had 13 paid orders; 9 were one-off. The free tier costs next to nothing in AI (under ₦11 in five weeks), so the shortfall is a volume problem, and the biggest lever is checkout conversion (section 3.2).

5. Backup restore test

Result: the backup restores, and the restored copy matches production. I ran the weekly off-site backup from GitHub (run 4, `dev` copy of the workflow), then restored that dump into a throwaway database inside the GitHub runner and counted rows. Nothing touched production except read-only counts. Production was not restored over, and nothing of yours can be damaged by it.

Table	Production	Restored copy	Result
profiles	269	269	match
subscriptions	21	21	match
payments	117	117	match
passes	5	5	match
predictions_log	1,555	1,555	match
partner_commissions	0	0	match
auth.users	269	269	match

- The restore took 14 seconds for the data. The whole job (dump, encrypt, upload, restore, compare) took about two minutes.

- The restore log showed 3 harmless errors: the scratch database already had a `public` schema, and a text-search helper (`unaccent`) was not installed in it. The helper is now installed in the scratch database so the log is clean next time.
- The encrypted dump was also saved as an artifact for 8 days, as the weekly job always does.
- **This drill now runs by itself every Sunday** with the backup, and turns the job red if any table comes back short. Supabase's own daily backups (your screenshot) are the first line; this is the independent second copy, and it is now proven to restore.
- What this does not prove: restoring a *Supabase* daily backup through their dashboard. That is their feature and I cannot run it without risking the live project; the weekly drill covers recoverability of the data itself. Item 1.3 is closed on that basis.

6. Ask KiqStat: lab results and a bug found

What the lab holds. One run only: 40 questions on one preset ("capped") on 5 November, costing US$0.032 (about US$0.0008 a question), with no ratings entered. I found no data for the other four presets, so the five-way comparison (3.2) has not happened. 39 of the 40 questions were answered; one gave no answer.

Question type	Questions	Average cost (US$)	Model calls	Answer length
Combo	6	0.00116	3.2	836 characters
Tool-heavy	6	0.00117	3.8	528
Analysis	6	0.00086	3.7	572
Price	6	0.00096	3.7	413
Simple	8	0.00065	3.1	328
Off-topic	5	0.00024	1.4	397
Live	3	0.00021	2.3	214

The most expensive single question cost US$0.0019, so the daily caps are never the limit in normal use.

The bug. In 4 of the 40 answers (3 combo, 1 analysis) the answer text appeared twice, run together, with a slightly different wording the second time. All four happened on the path where the assistant shows pick cards: it wrote the answer, called the cards tool, then wrote the answer again. Real users on that path would have read it twice. **Fixed on dev:** the system prompt now says to answer once and write nothing after the cards appear, and the cards tool tells the model the same thing in its result. A test guards the prompt wording.

For 3.2 to finish: run all five presets at `/admin/ask-lab` (about US$4) and rate the answers. If you did run them, the results are not in the database and the run may have failed; tell me and I will look at the logs.

7. What was built since the first pass (all on `dev`)

Change	Why
Daily subscription check recognises a charge reversed by the card issuer	1.5: no more "unexplained" alert for the 24 October case
An email to the founder whenever a Paystack refund reverses a partner commission, saying whether it was cancelled or needs deducting from the next manual payout	Partners are paid by hand; you must know
Partner commission ceiling lowered from 50% to 30%	5.2
VIP Ask allowance lowered from 100 to 80 a day (pricing page, plan list, docs)	2.5
Ask answers no longer repeat after the pick cards	Benchmark bug
`robots.txt` blocks `/football/h2h?` pair pages	The crawl trap, approved in 4.6
Restore drill added to the weekly off-site backup	1.3
Revenue statement updated with the Paystack reconciliation	2.1

Your pay-once decision needed no change: pay-once is already the main button on the billing page and "Auto-renew with a card instead" is the secondary link.

About the partner refund email. I read your note as: when a partner's customer is refunded, you receive an email so you can adjust the manual payout. That is what was built. If you meant something else (a partner asking you for a refund of their own purchase, or a partner requesting a payout), tell me and I will add that email too. Today partners have no self-service page, so there is nothing for them to request in the app.

8. What is still open

Item	Needs
Merge `dev` and promote	You. Nothing above is live until then

Item	Needs
2.5 follow-up	Nothing; done in code after the merge
3.2 Ask lab	Run all five presets and rate the answers
3.3 Ledger against Anthropic billing	Anthropic billing figures (October and November to date)
4.1 Site visits	GA4 figures and the Mixpanel bot-filter setting (the Vercel analysis is already in the SEO plan)
4.4 X test	Carousel images and the week's fixtures; the ad spend; then post and I run the 48-hour review (4.5)
4.6 SEO	Search Console verified (you ticked it); I need read access or exports to measure, plus the author line (you chose "the KiqStat team")
5.1, 5.3	Questionnaire answers; legal and tax with your adviser
Flutterwave	Whether it is used for partner customers (refund reversal only covers Paystack)
Dates	8 November: the ₦500 pass upgrade check and the two Pro renewals